

PAPER 1 Reading and
Use of English

PAPER 2 Writing

PAPER 3 Listening

PAPER 4 Speaking

Part 1

Part 2

Part 3

Part 4

Essential tips

- ▶ Make sure you listen to the entire extract before choosing your answer.
- ▶ Always try to choose your answer after the first listening, and confirm it after the second.
- ▶ Don't panic if you hear any words you don't recognise. Listen carefully and think about the context of what is being said.
- ▶ Listen for any stressed words. These often contain important information, either for specific details or for letting you know how the speaker feels.

Question 2: You need to identify something that surprised the man, something unusual, something he hadn't expected. What word in the extract signals this idea?

Question 3: In order to identify the woman's attitude, you need to listen to the points she makes, but also to her tone of voice. Read the answer options carefully. Which one best describes her attitude?

Question 4: Don't hurriedly choose an answer option just because you recognise a key word in the extract. Ensure that the full idea expressed in the answer you choose can be heard in the extract.

Question 6: You need to find out whether there is agreement between the speakers. Listen for language that indicates agreement or disagreement.

Track 5

You will hear three different extracts. For questions 1–6, choose the answer (A, B or C) which fits best according to what you hear. There are two questions for each extract.

Extract One

You hear a man making a phone call to deliver some good news.

- 1 Is the woman busy when her friend phones her?
 - A She is very busy.
 - B She is not busy at all.
 - ☒ C She is a little busy.
- 2 What surprised the man?
 - A that he had actually passed the driving test
 - ☒ B that he had felt so nervous before the test
 - C that his friend was nervous before her test

Extract Two

You hear a woman telling a friend about her experience at a careers fair.

- 3 What is the woman's attitude?
 - ☒ A pessimistic
 - B bored
 - C angry
- 4 What does the man advise the woman to do?
 - A speak to her parents
 - B become an accountant
 - ☒ C make a focused plan

Extract Three

You hear a woman discussing plans for her cousin's visit with a friend.

- 5 What is the man's criticism of the woman's plan?
 - A There won't be enough time to visit all the places.
 - ☒ B He is concerned that it might be too boring.
 - C Her cousin doesn't like museums or galleries.
- 6 Does the woman agree with the man's suggestion?
 - ☒ A Yes, she does.
 - B No, she doesn't.
 - C She is undecided.

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 Track 6

You will hear a travel writer describing her relationship with sleep. For questions 7–14, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

SLEEP, WONDERFUL SLEEP

The woman's guilty secret is that she schedules time for

(7) late afternoon naps on her trips.

According to the woman, a (8) side effect

of travelling is sleeping better.

The woman believes that our travel experience is extended when we sleep; it isn't a

(9) pause from it.

She comments that the sleep we experience when travelling tends to be significantly

more (10) intense.

For the speaker, getting over long-distance travel is particularly affected by

(11) local & cultural adjustments.

She finds that sleep while travelling is more (12) memorable

than what we experience at home.

The speaker refers to a trend called (13) slow travel, which

involves not rushing journeys.

In the end the speaker thinks she might (14) admit to her

fellow travellers how much she actually sleeps when she's on the road.

Essential tips

- ▶ Practise for this part of the test by listening to podcasts of lectures or presentations.
- ▶ Make the most of the time before the recording is first played by reading carefully through the rubric, the title and the set of statements. These will help you to think about the type of information you need.
- ▶ In this part of the test, all correct answers are the exact words or phrases as they are used in the recording. The statements may be paraphrased, but the missing words are not.
- ▶ If you are really not sure, you should make your best guess rather than leaving a blank space. No marks are deducted for getting an answer wrong, and you may have understood more than you realise.

Question 7: What does the speaker like doing when she travels? What part of speech follows *for*? What other words can you think of for *sleep*?

Question 9: Listen for a reference to the idea of travel being extended or stopping. This is where you will find the missing word or phrase.

Question 10: The use of the word *more* suggests that the speaker makes a comparison, and you know from the sentence structure that you need an adjective here. What adjective does she use?

Question 13: There is a reference to a trend here. What trend does the woman mention? Remember, she may use a term other than 'trend'.

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Track 7

You will hear a radio interview about the challenges which first-year college students often face. For questions 15–20, choose the answer (A, B, C or D) which fits best according to what you hear.

Essential tips

- ▶ This is the longest part of the Listening paper. Practise listening to recordings of this length so that you don't lose your focus before the end of the recording in the test.
- ▶ Pay attention to the question stem and listen for 'trigger' words. For example, if the question asks *How long ...?* listen for time frames.
- ▶ Remember, the questions appear in the same order as the information in the recording.
- ▶ Unlike Part 2, the answers in Part 3 may be paraphrased from the recording, so listen carefully for the key ideas.

Question 16: Notice the word *overall* in the question. Martin might mention various difficulties, but this tells you that you need to identify an overall, or main, problem.

Question 17: As always, pay close attention to how the question is phrased. Note that it doesn't ask what Martin says to the students, but what he emphasises to them.

Question 20: Pay attention to the pronoun *who* and listen for any mention of study groups. What does Martin say about them?

- 15 What does Martin Ferguson say about his job as an Information and Advice Officer?
 - A His professional background is working in customer service.
 - B He recruits students and enrolls them at Stanmere College.
 - x C He helps students before and after they begin their course.
 - D He works exclusively with the first year university students.
- 16 Martin says that, overall, the most common difficulty for students starting college is
 - A the new environment.
 - B the volume of work.
 - C too much freedom.
 - x D time management.
- 17 What does Martin emphasise to students?
 - A that there isn't any shame in being weak
 - x B that how they're feeling is very common
 - C that all of their friends are struggling too
 - D that it's important to show their feelings
- 18 Regarding finances, what does Martin give his students?
 - A a course in financial management
 - B tricks for saving their money
 - C a pre-made budget for students
 - x D tips on how to spend less money
- 19 Primarily, according to Martin, additional difficulties include students'
 - x A physical and psychological well-being.
 - B concerns about failing their exams.
 - C anxieties about their family back home.
 - D lack of meaningful friendships.
- 20 Who does Martin recommend study groups to?
 - A students who are worried about exams
 - B students who like clubs and societies
 - x C students who are not very outgoing
 - D students who might be depressed

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Track 8

You will hear five short extracts in which people talk about the things they do to reduce stress.

While you listen you must complete both tasks.

TASK ONE

For questions **21–25**, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker says about what brought them to this particular practice.

A was worried about taxes

B was busy relocating

C takes on too much

D had left a busy job

E lost a family member

F does it for free at the gym

G lacked a healthy balance

H has a very physical job

Speaker 1 **C** 21

Speaker 2 **E** 22

Speaker 3 **B** 23

Speaker 4 **H** 24

Speaker 5 **G** 25

TASK TWO

For questions **26–30**, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker says about the effect the practice has on them.

A gets a tranquil feeling

B sleeps more often

C feels a burden lifted

D gained some weight

E feels their mind has cleared

F is totally relaxed

G no longer has nightmares

H thinks life seems less hectic

Speaker 1 **C** 26

Speaker 2 **E** 27

Speaker 3 **A** 28

Speaker 4 **F** 29

Speaker 5 **H** 30

Essential tips

- ▶ As this part of the test focuses on gist and attitude, a good way to practise for it is to study the kind of vocabulary that expresses feelings and attitudes.
- ▶ The series of five short recordings will be played through once and then replayed. Unlike in Part 1, they will not be played and replayed one at a time.
- ▶ Practise working on two tasks at once.
- ▶ The instructions will tell you what the common theme is. Take a moment to try and predict what you might hear in the recording.
- ▶ Even though the speakers may mention practices you have never heard of before, don't worry. You won't be asked questions about the practices themselves, only how the speaker started doing them and how they feel afterwards.

Questions 21–25:

Option B: What does *relocating* mean? Do any of the speakers talk about this?

Option E: *Lost a family member* is another way of saying what? Does anyone make reference to this?

Option F: Does anyone mention the gym and, importantly, do they say anything about not paying fees?

Questions 26–30:

Option A: What is another way of saying *tranquil*? Who, if anyone, makes specific reference to this?

Option B: Be sure to consider the entire phrase in each option. Does anyone mention sleep and, if so, do they say they sleep more often now?

Option H: More than one speaker may describe their life as being hectic, but does anyone specifically say the effect of the practice is that their life now feels less crazy?